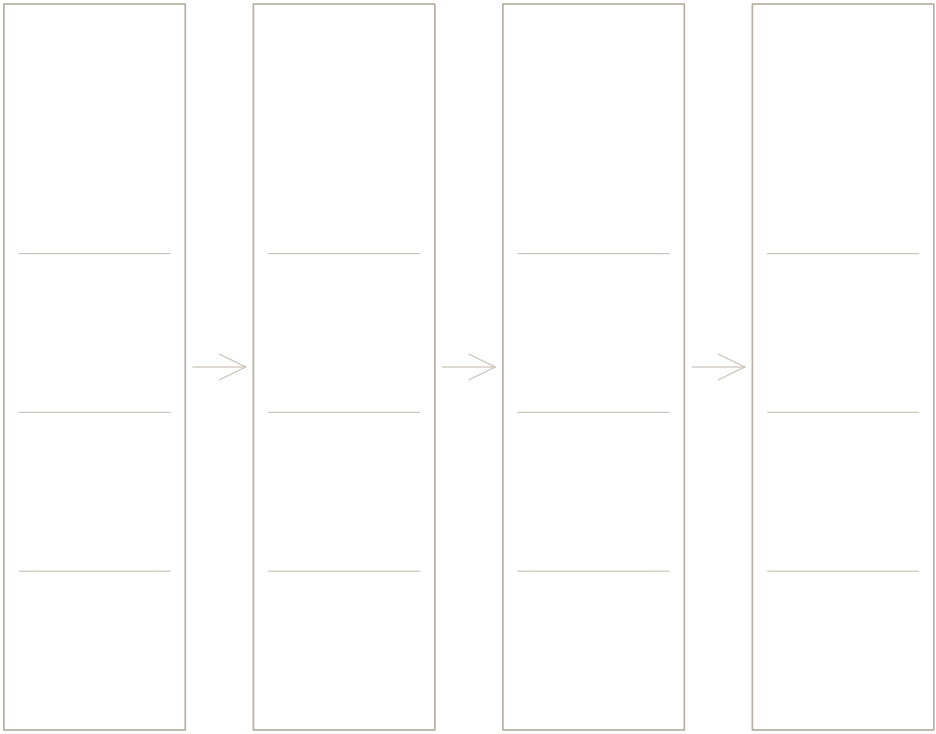Four-step horizontal flow